FREE EXERCISE

Under Your *Skin*

For the one person you can’t stop replaying. Find the exact action that gets to you, see where it lives in your own life, and what it has given you. About 15 minutes.

INSIDE

1. Name them
2. Who
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11. Look again
12. Reflect, and your next step

> *“The size of a reaction shows you what you can’t yet see.”*
>
> SAM OSBORNE

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Before you start

Most of what holds capable people back isn't a lack of skill. It's one person whose words you replay at 2 a.m. This exercise turns the label you've given them into one action a camera could record, then helps you find that same action in your own life, and what it has given you.

TIME
About 15 minutes

WHERE
Somewhere quiet, uninterrupted

HOW
A pen, one person, one moment. Try each step before you read the examples.

1 Name them

Who's getting under your skin right now? Pick the one person who carries the most charge.

- [ ] A family member
- [ ] Someone at work
- [ ] A friend
- [ ] My partner
- [ ] A client or customer
- [ ] Someone else

In one sentence, what's going on: _____

2 Who

Who is it? First name or initials.

One person, not a group. If you wrote "people," "my clients," or "lawyers," pick one person and one moment.

Who: _____

EXAMPLES
My manager, Priya My husband, Dave My brother Mark

3 Say it your way

What did they do, in your own words? Labels welcome here.

> **Circle any verdicts** like manipulative, dismissed, selfish, rude, toxic, liar, fraud, controlling, always, never, "made me feel." These are verdicts. We'll find the action under them next.

EXAMPLES
"My boss strung me along." "My husband never listens." "My mum is so critical."

4 The literal line

What exactly did they say or do? The words, or what a camera would have caught.

Still see a label? Labels aren't endpoints. What would a camera have caught? Swap "always" or "never" for one time.

FROM LABEL TO LITERAL

~~"My boss strung me along"~~	→ He said, "You'll make partner next year." A year later, he didn't raise it.
~~"She dismissed me"~~	→ She looked at her phone while I was presenting.
~~"My husband never listens"~~	→ He kept watching the game while I told him about my day.
~~"My mum is critical"~~	→ She said, "Are you really wearing that?"

5 Observed or reported?

- [ ] I saw or heard it myself (live or on video)
- [ ] I was told or read about it

Reported actions carry less weight. If you have a moment you witnessed directly, use that one.

EXAMPLES

Observed: "I was in the meeting." "I was at the dinner table."

Reported: "A colleague told me." "My sister told me." "I saw it in a group chat."

6 What still stings

Which part carries the charge? Underline it in step 4, or write it here.

The first label often isn't the real trigger.

EXAMPLE

In "You'll make partner next year," the charge might sit in the promise itself, the confidence it was said with, or the year of silence that followed.

7 Your Motor Function

Say the action in 3–4 words, starting with a verb.

One word per box. A physical action, not a verdict.

VERB	2	3	4 (OPTIONAL)

Could a camera record this? ☐ Yes ☐ Not yet: picture the moment on video. What do their hands, face, or mouth do? Start with that verb.

FROM LABEL TO MOTOR FUNCTION

~~"Strung me along"~~	→ Promises what isn't delivered
~~"Dismissive"~~	→ Looks away while I speak
~~"Controlling"~~	→ Requests approval before sending
~~"Ignores me"~~	→ Withholds a reply
~~"Rude"~~	→ Interrupts before I finish

8 Score it

Right now, how one-sided does it feel? Mark the scale.

0 means it's all upside. 100 means it's all cost. Most people start near 100.

0 10 20 30 40 50 60 70 80 90 100

All upside — Balanced · 50 / 50 — All cost

My score (0–100): _____

How strongly does it pull on you? (1) (2) (3) (4) (5) (6) (7) (8) (9) (10)

9 Turn the mirror

MY MOTOR FUNCTION _____

Where have *you* done this exact action, in any form?

Keep going until you can honestly say you've done it as much as they have. Who was there, when, what you said. Aim for at least three areas.

Spiritual #

Mental #

Vocational #

Financial #

Family/Domestic #

Social #

Physical #

Total: _____ moments across _____ of 7 areas

WORKED EXAMPLE: A MANAGER WHO SAID "YOU'LL MAKE PARTNER NEXT YEAR," AND 'PROMISES WHAT ISN'T DELIVERED.' USE THESE AS PLACES TO LOOK, THEN WRITE YOUR OWN MOMENT.

Spiritual: Spoke a commitment aloud and later acted against it · Committed to a practice and stopped showing up

Mental: "Let me think it over and get back to you," then no reply

Vocational: Told a client "You'll have it Friday," and it went out Tuesday · "We'll look at a raise soon," then didn't

Financial: "I'll pay you back," then paid late, less, or never

Family/Domestic: "I'll be home for dinner," then stayed late · Told your partner "This weekend I'll fix it"

Social: "Let's get coffee soon" and never sent a date · RSVP'd yes and didn't go

Physical: Told your doctor "I'll cut back," then didn't

Tightest matches have the same order: you promised first, to get a yes, then didn't deliver.

10 The other side

From the moment you saw them do it, how has it served you?

- What has this pushed you to learn, build, or become?
- Where has it made you stronger, sharper, or more determined?
- If a close friend had lived this, what would it have given them?

Spiritual #

Mental #

Vocational #

Financial #

Family/Domestic #

Social #

Physical #

Total: _____ benefits across _____ of 7 areas

WORKED EXAMPLE: A MANAGER WHO SAID "YOU'LL MAKE PARTNER NEXT YEAR," AND 'PROMISES WHAT ISN'T DELIVERED.' USE THESE AS PLACES TO LOOK, THEN WRITE YOUR OWN MOMENT.

Spiritual: Got clear on what you actually want from your work · Learned to trust your own read

Mental: Learned to ask "What exactly has to happen, and by when?"

Vocational: Built the case for your own promotion · Now give your team clear criteria

Financial: Negotiated harder on your next offer

Family/Domestic: More evenings at home once you stopped over-working for the promise

Social: Rebuilt your network outside the company

Physical: Took the holiday you'd been putting off

Their undelivered promise delivered something to you.

11 Look again

Look at it again. Where is it now? Don't aim for a number. Just notice.

0 10 20 30 40 50 60 70 80 90 100

All upside — Balanced · 50 / 50 — All cost

Before: _____ **After:** _____ **Points toward balance:** _____

12 Reflect

What did you notice as you worked through this?

If this no longer ran you, what would you do differently this week?

This is where a session begins.

If the number barely moved, that's normal. In a private session we take the one person you named today and work it through completely, one-to-one, by video.

Book a free 20-minute call calendly.com/sam-samosborne/20min

> *"One session with Sam cleared more black clouds than anything I have ever previously experienced."*
>
> Graham Harvey · Professional Speakers Australia Hall of Fame

About Sam. Sam Osborne is a trained Demartini Method Facilitator and a keynote speaker on conflict and composure for attorneys, advisors, and executives. He works privately with clients in 10 countries. Learn more at samosborne.net.

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